

● Pakistan

Has objections to the Kishanganga and Tulbul projects on the Jhelum and the Salal on the Chenab, besides the Baghlihar dam project

● China

Beijing has shared some flood data but New Delhi fears China may be diverting water from the Upper Brahmaputra

Water Woes

India faces a virtual war over issues related to control and sharing of water resources with almost all its neighbours



● Bangladesh

Has issues over sharing of Ganges water at Farrakha Barrage and dispute over the Teesta water still unresolved

● Nepal

The Pancheshwar and the Saptakosi high dam projects are stuck but Kathmandu remains non-committal

TROUBLED TREATIES

Despite more than two dozen institutional mechanisms and a slew of treaties, India's water troubles with its neighbours have only grown over time.

The Indus Water Treaty signed in 1960 allots rivers Ravi, Sutlej, Beas to India, and the Indus, Jhelum and Chenab to Pakistan.

The Ganges Water Treaty was signed in 1996 for sharing water at the Farrakha Barrage. But water sharing during lean season is disputed.

treaty. It now seeks damages for the alleged loss to its farmers, a charge that has been contested by India.

River waters between India and Pakistan have been shared under the Indus Water Treaty in 1960, which allots three eastern rivers (the Ravi, Sutlej and Beas) to India and the three western rivers (the Indus, Jhelum, and Chenab) to Pakistan. Being the upper riparian state, India is allowed to have a run of the river projects that do not stop the flow of water of the three rivers allotted to Pakistan. "Water is a

precious resource and every country has an equitable share of these resources. We have settled our problems with our neighbours through treaties which are working well. They have made some demands and we are settling them through institutional mechanisms," says External Affairs Minister Pranab Mukherjee.

While the minister is diplomatic about the issue, the fact is that the issue of water resources bitterly divides India and Pakistan. Last year Pakistan took the Baghlihar issue for interna-

tional arbitration, where the expert ruled in favour of India and allowed it to go ahead with the project. The Rs 4,500-crore Baghlihar project on the Chenab in the Doda district of Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) has assumed a large political dimension because of one key reason. Pakistan believes it will act as a catalyst for New Delhi's plans to bring economic progress to J&K. Pakistan also has apprehensions that India's plans to build dams on its rivers may lead to water shortage and even floods if India were